

CLINICAL POLICY BULLETIN: TOTAL JOINT REPLACEMENT

Policy Number: CPB-2026-ORTH-003 (SYNTHETIC)

1. Medical Necessity Criteria

All required: radiographic evidence (Kellgren-Lawrence 3-4); persistent pain 6+ months; failure of conservative treatment (physical therapy 6 weeks, NSAIDs, corticosteroid injection); BMI < 40 (or weight optimization plan if 40-45); no active infection; medical clearance.

2. Covered Post-operative Services

Physical therapy up to 12 weeks (3x/week tapering), home health nursing (first 2 weeks), DME (walker then cane), one post-op imaging at 6 weeks. Revision requires separate prior auth.